

Document Description

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2.0	PL encashment criteria changed	09 June 2023
1.0	Leave Policy created	09 June 2020

Leave Policy

PURPOSE OF LEAVE:

Leave is granted to employees with the good intention of providing rest, recuperation of health and fulfilling social & personal obligations. This provides for a healthy and efficient workforce for the company.

LEAVE CALENDAR AND APPLICABILITY:

1. Sanctioning of leave is based on exigencies of business or seriousness of the case.
2. Leave calendar is from 1st January to 31st December.
3. Casual Leave (CL) will be credited at the beginning of each quarter, and Privileged Leave (PL) will be credited at the start of each month along with an additional credit at the beginning of each quarter.
4. Eligible leaves start getting credited to the employees from the applicable accrual cycle (monthly/quarterly) beginning 1st January every year.
5. The different types of leaves given under the policy are:
 - i. Casual (Sick) Leave (CL)
 - ii. Privileged (Earned) Leave (PL)
 - iii. Maternity Leave (ML)
 - iv. Paternity Leave (PL)
 - v. Loss of Pay (LOP)
 - vi. Comp Off
6. The Leave policy is applicable for all permanent employees of the company.
7. Employees who are appointed during the year shall be entitled to the above leaves on pro-rata basis.
8. During probation, employees cannot avail Privileged Leaves (PL). However, they are entitled to Casual Leave (CL) on a pro-rata basis. The accrued PLs during probation will be credited to the employee's leave balance post confirmation.
9. Any leave taken during notice period will be considered as Loss of pay.

CASUAL (SICK) LEAVE (CL)

ELIGIBILITY:

All permanent employees

Casual leave is calculated for a period of one year (January to December)

ENTITLEMENT:

1. Employees are entitled to 2 days of Casual (+Sick) Leave per quarter, accrued at the beginning of each quarter.
2. Intervening National / Festival / Declared holidays will NOT be counted as part of the leave.
3. Employees whose date of joining falls within the first 15 days of a quarter will be eligible for Casual Leave (CL) for that respective quarter. Employees joining after the first 15th day of the quarter will not be eligible for CL for that quarter.
4. Casual Leave (CL) must be utilized within the same quarter. Any unutilized CL balance will lapse at the start of the next quarter. Additionally, any unused CL will also lapse at the start of the next calendar year.
5. In case of separation—employees leaving within the first 15 days of a quarter will not be eligible for that quarter's credit, while those leaving after the first 15th day of the quarter will be eligible.
6. When leave is taken without prior approval (under certain unavoidable circumstances), the absence should be notified to the respective account manager on the same day via E-mail/Text/Call.
7. CL will automatically lapse at the time of leaving. CL cannot be adjusted against notice period and are not eligible for encashment.

PRIVILEGED (EARNED) LEAVE (PL)

ENTITLEMENT:

All permanent employees.

1. 16 days of Privileged Leave in a calendar year (January to December).
2. Employees will be entitled to 1 PL per month at the start of the month and 1 PL at the beginning of each quarter.
3. For monthly PL credit, employees joining on or before the 15th of the month will be eligible for that month's PL. Those joining after the 15th will not be eligible. Similarly, employees leaving on or before the 15th will not be eligible for that month's PL credit.
4. For quarterly PL credit, employees joining on or before the first 15th day of the quarter will be eligible for that quarter's PL. Those joining after the 15th day of the quarter will not be eligible. Similarly, employees leaving on or before the first 15th day of the quarter will not be eligible for that quarter's PL credit.
5. Employees are required to avail the mandatory 10 Privilege Leaves (PL) each year (on pro-rata basis); if not taken, these 10 mandatory PL will lapse at the start of next year.
6. During Probation, the employee cannot avail the PLs, however the accrued PLs during probation will be credited to the employee's leave balance post confirmation.
7. PL can be availed only on prior approval.
8. Intervening National / declared / festival / weekly off days will NOT BE counted as part of the leave.
9. Any un-availed Earned/Privileged leave at the end of the year will be carried forward up to a maximum of 45 (forty-five) days.
10. Maximum PL balance is capped at 45 days at any given month. Any balance above 45 will lapse at month-end.

MATERNITY LEAVE (ML)

ELIGIBILITY:

All married female employees

ENTITLEMENT:

1. To qualify for maternity leave benefits an employee must have completed at least six months of service with the company by the qualifying week (i.e. week before the expected week of confinement)
2. All employees are statutorily entitled to ML of 26 weeks twice (not more than 8 weeks before the confinement and rest thereafter) either during pregnancy or in case of non-willful medical termination of pregnancy
3. 26 weeks will be calculated including weekends and holidays falling in ML duration
4. ML will automatically start (if it has not already begun) on the day baby is born
5. Full monthly salary as per most recent agreement with employee will be paid to her during ML
6. All such leave period must be intimated at least 30 days prior to availing this leave
7. Employee along with managers' help should create a backup/make alternate arrangements/ transferring tasks/assignments/responsibilities to cover her absence
8. An employee on ML can club her unused privilege leave and casual leave along with her maternity leave
9. ML cannot be compensated in case employee is leaving in said duration
10. Nursing mother shall be allowed 4 visits a day to the crèche which shall include the interval for rest allowed to her
11. Before applying for ML, HR should be informed so that ML can be credited to the account in HR records.

Miscarriage: In case of miscarriage and medical termination of pregnancy, employee shall, on production of appropriate medical proof, be entitled to leave with salary at the rate of maternity benefit for a period of six weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage.

Adoption or Surrogacy: In case of adoption of a child below the age of three months or a commissioning mother both shall be entitled to maternity benefit for a period of twelve weeks from the date the child is handed over to the adopting mother or the commissioning mother, as the case may be.

PATERNITY LEAVE (PATL)

ELIGIBILITY:

All married male employees

ENTITLEMENT:

1. All employees are statutorily entitled to PATL of 5 days within a month from when the baby is born.

LOSS OF PAY (LOP)

1. LOP can be applied by an employee when no other leave is available.
2. A maximum of 3 months of LOP can be availed on the approval of the management. (Exceptional cases like ML/SL, etc.)
3. If the employee fails to report to duty on the specified date after the sanctioned LOP, it is deemed that the employee has abandoned his service with the company on his own accord.
4. LOP can be implicated on disciplinary grounds about attendance by the management regardless to the availability of the other types of leave.
5. In case of no CL balance during probation, any additional leave taken will be considered as LOP.
6. Any leave taken without prior approval of the reporting manager will be considered as LOP, irrespective of CL and PL balance.

COMPENSATORY OFF (COMPOFF)

1. If an employee is required to work on any important assignment on a National / Festival / Declared / weekly off day, he/she is eligible for Compensatory off on any other working day.
2. Official approval is required from the Account Manager / Management to work on such National / Festival / Declared / weekly off days. No compensatory offs will be entertained when worked on these days without proper approval.
3. The compensatory off must be availed within a period of 45 days from the date worked, if not availed within the stipulated period it would get lapsed.
4. The un-utilized comp off's will get lapsed by end of calendar year.

LEAVE SETTLEMENT DURING RESIGNATION/ RETIREMENT / TERMINATION:

1. PL for the days worked till the employee's date of relieving will be calculated and paid during the final settlement, provided he / she fulfils PL eligibility criteria.
2. In case PL's are available at the time of resignation then the same can be adjusted with notice only at manager's discretion
3. If PL's are not adjusted with notice period, then the same will be eligible for encashment. The encashment will be based on basic salary which will be settled with full and final settlement.
4. Any employee leaving during probation period, will not be eligible for PL encashment or adjustment (with notice period).
5. Any leave taken during notice period will be considered as LOP and same will be considered for full and final settlement.

PROCEDURE FOR APPLYING LEAVE

All leaves are to be applied on the Zoho Portal.

Given below link is the stepwise process for applying the leave on the Zoho portal by employees. [Zoho Login=>Leave Tracker=>Leave Request=>Add Request](#)

*Reporting managers can also apply for leave on behalf of the employees if found not recorded in the system or the latter is unable to apply for the leave in the system due to some personal exigency.

***The leaves approved or rejected by the manager will be notified to the employee through an auto generation email from Zoho.**

CANCELLATION OF LEAVE

The Reporting manager can also cancel the once sanctioned leave on situational / need basis. If an employee proceeds to avail the cancelled leave, then those days will be treated as absence from work and the rules pertaining to absence from duty will be applied.

EXTENSION OF LEAVE

As it is necessary to get prior approval for leave so it is also for extension of leave. The employee must apply to his/her account manager for extension of leave well in advance and get it sanctioned to avail them. In case an employee overstays, the unsanctioned leave availed will be treated as absence from work.

ABSENCE FROM WORK

1. When an employee takes off from duty without prior leave approval or proper intimation under certain unavoidable circumstances, then those day/days will be treated as absence from duty.
2. The days of absence will be treated under Loss of Pay
3. The employee must report to his / her account manager on rejoining duty from absence and provide valid reasons for absence in writing before taking up work again.
4. If an employee is absent from duty continuously for more than 8 days (including any National / Festival / Declared / weekly off days which may fall in-between), an official correspondence from the HR department will be sent to the employee asking to report to duty and to provide explanation for his/her absence.
5. Based on the enquiry any action deemed fit will/would be taken by the management.
6. If there were no response from the employee within the stipulated time mentioned in official correspondence, it would be assumed that the employee has withdrawn his/her service from the company on his/her own accord and recorded accordingly.